



Candidate Name: _____ Interviewer: _____ Date: _____ Score: _____

TOP 10 MICROSOFT SQL SERVER INTERVIEW QUESTIONS

Core mechanisms, architecture, production configs & identity integration

PART 1: QUESTIONS 1 - 5

Q1

What type of database is Microsoft SQL Server (relational, document, key-value, graph, time-series) and what are its strengths?

Fundamentals

Answer:

Q2

Explain how Microsoft SQL Server handles ACID properties or the consistency model it provides.

Architecture

Answer:

Q3

How does indexing work in Microsoft SQL Server? What index types are available and how do you choose one?

Configuration

Answer:

Q4

What is the data model in Microsoft SQL Server and how do you design a schema for a typical use case?

Security Ops

Answer:

Q5

How does Microsoft SQL Server handle scaling: vertical scaling, horizontal sharding, or replication?

Integration

Answer:



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TOP 10 MICROSOFT SQL SERVER INTERVIEW QUESTIONS

Credential lifecycle, audit, compliance, vulnerability testing & performance

PART 2: QUESTIONS 6 - 10

Q6

Describe the read/write performance characteristics of Microsoft SQL Server and how to tune them.

Key Mgmt

Answer:

Q7

How do you handle transactions in Microsoft SQL Server? What isolation levels or guarantees are supported?

Monitoring

Answer:

Q8

What backup and point-in-time recovery strategies does Microsoft SQL Server support?

Compliance

Answer:

Q9

How do you monitor and diagnose slow queries or performance issues in Microsoft SQL Server?

Pen-Testing

Answer:

Q10

What are common anti-patterns or pitfalls to avoid when using Microsoft SQL Server in production?

Performance

Answer:
